Try it at the table

How Animals Get Ready for Winter

Gather your things, then try each one. Guess first. Then look closely and write or draw what you saw.

What you need

- ☐ Paper and crayons
- ☐ A timer
- ☐ A freezer
- ☐ Two jars with lids
- ☐ Warm tap water
- ☐ A thick towel or socks
- ☐ Two kitchen thermometers
- ☐ A bag of cotton balls
- ☐ Paper and pencil

TRY 1 How can a wood frog freeze and live?

1. Draw a big circle for one frog cell.
2. Draw ice crystals only outside the circle.
3. Draw sugar dots near the cell.
4. Tell how the sugar helps keep the cell safe while ice forms around it.

I THINK…

_____

_____

_____

I SAW…

_____

_____

_____

TRY 2 How does a chipmunk save energy all winter?

1. Sit very still and count your breaths for 30 seconds.
2. Then march in place for 30 seconds and count again.
3. Tell which time used more energy.
4. In torpor, an animal slows its body way down to save energy.

I THINK…

_____

_____

_____

I SAW…

_____

_____

_____

TRY 3 How do honeybees stay warm without hibernating?

1. Fill two jars with warm tap water and close the lids.
2. Wrap one jar in a thick towel or some socks, like the outside bees.
3. Leave the other jar bare.
4. Wait 20 minutes, then touch both jars and tell which one stayed warmer.

I THINK...

_____

_____

_____

I SAW...

_____

_____

_____

TRY 4 Why can a mouse stay warmer under the snow?

1. Put two kitchen thermometers in the freezer.
2. Bury one in a thick pile of cotton balls, like a snow blanket.
3. Leave the other one bare.
4. After 20 minutes, read both and tell which one is warmer.

I THINK...

_____

_____

_____

I SAW...

_____

_____

_____